ANGIE
ACADEMIC NETWORK FOR A GREEN & INNOVATIVE EUROPE

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Newsletter 10

University of Žilina National Seminar: Maritime Transport as a Sustainable Transport Mode:

How can maritime transport become a driver of sustainable logistics and EU policy? That question was at the heart of the national seminar organised by the University of Žilina as part of the ANGIE project.

The seminar was organised on 16 January 2026 in Žilina, Slovakia, and it brought together 14 participants, including educators and staff with an interest in maritime transport, logistics, sustainability, and EU-related policy education. Titled “Maritime Transport as a Sustainable Transport Mode,” the session was led by Assoc. Prof. Andrej Dávid, PhD., who provided an interdisciplinary perspective linking maritime transport to European policymaking, sustainability goals, and international supply chains.

The main objective was to deepen understanding of maritime transport as an environmentally efficient component of global trade. Participants explored key elements such as energy efficiency, emissions reduction, green ports, and the integration of maritime transport into intermodal logistics systems. The discussion also addressed current challenges, including environmental regulations, digitalisation, and the transition to low-emission technologies.

Special attention was given to the role of higher education institutions in preparing students for sustainable transport systems.

Educators and staff reflected on their own teaching practices and discussed practical ways to incorporate sustainability-focused maritime topics into their curricula.

By the end of the seminar, participants gained new insights into maritime sustainability, exchanged ideas on best practices, strengthened professional networks, and laid the groundwork for future collaboration.

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University of Žilina Hosts National Workshop on Maritime Transport and Sustainability

On 12 January 2026, the University of Žilina hosted its national workshop in Žilina, Slovakia, bringing together 16 participants, including university lecturers with a strong interest in maritime transport, logistics, sustainability, and EU-related policy education.

Under the title **Maritime Transport and Maritime Containers**, the workshop offered a lively and interdisciplinary discussion on how maritime shipping drives global trade and connects to sustainable development. Assoc. Prof. Andrej Dávid, PhD. led the session, situating maritime transport within the wider context of European policymaking, logistics systems, and international economic relations, while also recognizing the value of diverse perspectives, including those of female participants, in shaping discussions on transport-related issues.

Throughout the workshop, participants engaged with key themes such as intermodal transport, port operations, and the environmental implications of maritime logistics. The discussions also highlighted practical ways of incorporating these topics into teaching and research, as well as the kinds of institutional support needed to ensure long-term impact.

A particular focus was placed on the role of higher education institutions in equipping students to respond to the challenges of global logistics. The workshop created space for educators to exchange good practices, strengthen professional connections, and explore opportunities for future collaboration.

At the end of the workshop, Participants left the event with a deeper understanding of how containerised shipping influences global trade and how sustainability can be meaningfully embedded in maritime logistics education.

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Connecting Trade, Education, and Sustainability: A Round Table on Maritime Transport

What role does maritime transport play in connecting global trade, education, and sustainability? These questions guided discussions in the national round table organised by the University of Žilina, which took place on 14 January 2026 in Žilina, Slovakia.

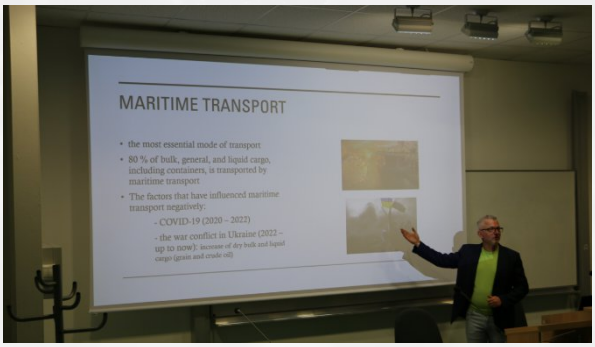
The event brought together ten female participants, mainly university lecturers with an interest in maritime transport, logistics, sustainability, and EU-related policy education. Titled "**Maritime Transport**", the round table created an engaging opportunity for reflection and exchange on the growing importance of maritime transport in economic development and international connectivity.

Assoc. Prof. Andrej Dávid, PhD., provided an interdisciplinary perspective that situated maritime transport within the wider context of European policymaking, logistics systems, and international economic relations. This broader framing helped participants explore the technical aspects of the topic, including its policy and educational relevance.

The main objective of the round table was to deepen participants' understanding of maritime transport, its structure, and its role in global supply chains. Discussions focused on shipping routes, port infrastructure, and intermodal transport systems, while also addressing current challenges such as environmental sustainability, digitalisation, and disruptions in international logistics.

Particular attention was given to the role of higher education in preparing students for careers in transport and logistics.

Participants reflected on teaching practices and explored ways to integrate maritime transport topics more effectively into curricula. The round table also served as a platform for exchanging good practices, strengthening professional networks, and encouraging future collaboration among participants.



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ANGIE Partners Join Forces in Steyr for a Final Push

It was a productive couple of days in Steyr on 24–25 March 2026, where the University of Applied Sciences Upper Austria hosted to the ANGIE consortium for our 3rd Transnational Partner Meeting.

Partners from across Europe came together in person, while others joined online, for two days of focused discussion, exchange, and coordination as the project enters its final stage.

The meeting provided an important opportunity to review progress across Work Packages 2, 3, and 4, and to align on the priorities for next months.

Discussions covered major project outputs, dissemination activities, financial management, and administrative reporting, helping to ensure that all partners remain coordinated as ANGIE moves toward its conclusion.

One of the key highlights of the meeting was the finalisation of the Transnational Action Plan, which sets out broader measures to support the green transition across Europe. The plan considers the green transition and the role of higher education, as well as companies and organisations in sectors such as transport, energy production, agriculture, waste management, construction, industrial activities, and residential activities.

The meeting was a chance to think about what comes next, how the consortium can keep collaborating and make sure ANGIE's results keep making a difference long after the project wraps up.

A huge thank you to the University of Applied Sciences Upper Austria for hosting the partners so warmly in Steyr, and to all our partners for the great energy, commitment, and teamwork that made this gathering such a valuable one

Final Editorial Note

As ANGIE comes to a close, this newsletter marks the end of a collaborative journey that began in 2023. Over the course of the project, partners worked together to build the Academic Network for Green and Innovative Europe and to promote new ways of thinking about sustainability, climate change, and the green transition through higher education and cooperation. The project was designed to both raise awareness, and strengthen green competences among educators, specialists, and stakeholders.

An important ambition of ANGIE was the development of the graduate study programme "*Transition to Green for a Sustainable Society*, alongside pilot learning activities, dissemination efforts, and sustainability-oriented actions. In this way, the project combined academic collaboration with practical engagement, supporting both the creation of learning resources and the broader exchange of ideas across institutions and countries.

This final newsletter issue is not only a reflection on recent activities, but also an opportunity to recognise the shared effort behind the project as a whole. Through seminars, workshops, discussions, and joint work across the consortium, ANGIE has contributed to ongoing conversations on green skills, innovative learning, and the role of education in shaping a more sustainable future.

As the formal project period ends, the partnerships, knowledge, and momentum created through ANGIE are intended to continue beyond the project itself.

Prof. Ionel-Dănuț Savu
Project Coordinator, ANGIE
University of Craiova
On behalf of the ANGIE Consortium

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